

with humanity — until Banality and the Shattering severed Earth from the Dreaming. To the Kithain it was an unfathomable disaster. To the Thallain, it was an unparalleled opportunity — the Tuathan Dream was finally losing its grip on the world. Without the Kithain maintaining it, the Silver Ban began to weaken.

Beginning with the Black Plague, periodic horrors of human history caused Dark Glamour to infuse the ancient Fomorian Trods with enough power to briefly pierce the Silver Ban, allowing small bands of Thallain to return. Any time humanity collectively gave in to despair — the conquest and plagues of the Native Americans, the African slave trade, the Chinese opium trade, the French Revolution, and so many others — a few more Thallain found their way to Earth. They called the events Tarraroms.

Throughout the 20th century, the frequency of Tarraroms increased dramatically: trench and chemical warfare, the Holocaust, Cold War paranoia, ethnic cleansing, existential dread of nuclear weaponry, and the utter futility of the Vietnam War. By the time the moon landing brought about the Resurgence, the Fomorian Trods were charged and the Thallain ready to fight a guerrilla war against the sidhe upon returning to the Autumn Realm. The Tarraroms continued at a fever pitch, finally reaching a crescendo at the dawn of the 21st century.

Kithain named the event the Evanescence. Mortals know it as September 11, 2001, the day a group of terrorists executed the largest foreign attack on American soil, a nation that previously believed itself impervious to invasion. Thousands were killed, and the world changed almost overnight. Across the globe, travel was restricted, police powers were drastically increased, expansive surveillance programs were put into place, and entire nations were destabilized, all in the name of security. The last vestiges of the Silver Ban restricting the Thallain burned out in the onslaught of Dark Glamour, and the children of the Fomorians flooded back to Earth in numbers rivaling the sidhe during the Resurgence.

Today, the Thallain use their newfound freedom to subvert or destroy Concordia and other changeling societies across the Autumn Realm. Some work through the Shadow Court, corrupting unwary Unseelie and fostering animosity between the nobles and commoners. Others work independently, outright attacking Kithain institutions and Glamour sources. Still others revel in violence and atrocity for its own sake. Leaders among the Thallain, known as the Black Court in honor of their ancient masters, don't mind these senseless individuals, for even they further the cause of the Fomorian Dream. They hunger for the day humanity is eradicated, the Tuathan Dream is extinguished, and the Fomorians are loose once more, returning the world to its original brutality.

Building a Monster

Thallain character creation is similar to that of Kithain characters. They have the same Attributes, Abilities, Backgrounds, Willpower, Glamour, and Banality. They both use the same Arts and Realms. Where a Thallain differs from her Kithain counterparts is in her seemings and Legacies. Consult Chapter Three: Character Creation & Traits for more information about character creation.

Seemings

Thallain have three seemings. Like the Kithain seemings, they represent a Thallain's outlook and approach to interacting with the world around her. Usually, a Thallain progresses through her seemings in order from childling to wilder to grump, but that is not always the case. A Thallain may change seemings whenever her worldview changes, just like the Kithain. She uses the same criteria and rules as a Kithain when she switches seemings.

Childling: Perturbed

Like Kithain childlings, the Thallain perturbed see the world as new and unexplored. Unlike childlings, who see it as source of delight and experimentation, the perturbed fear the unknown. Anything a perturbed has never encountered before is best avoided. If it cannot be avoided, it should be destroyed to keep their world comfortable and familiar. They become confused and angry when something doesn't go as expected and often violently lash out.

Trigger: A perturbed invites Banality when she goes along with a new experience or spends extended time in an unfamiliar location while not in pursuit of her Legacy's Urge.

Immunity: If something does not please a perturbed, it does not deserve to exist. Destroying any kind of dross, chimerical item, or Treasure never triggers Banality.

Wilder: Prowler

Prowlers, like Kithain wilders, leave the comforts of their homes to venture out into the world. While wilders search for fame, glory, and adventure, prowlers seek ways to satiate their base Urges and gorge themselves on Dark Glamour. They stalk the streets looking for any opportunity to indulge or any prey upon which to feed. Pursuit of their dark hunger drives them, leading them to commit acts unthinkable to the Kithain.

Trigger: Passing up an opportunity to fulfill his Urge or gather Dark Glamour triggers Banality.

Immunity: A prowler cannot gain Banality through Ravaging or Rhapsody. Additionally, he may spend any amount of time around high Banality without being triggered as long as he is fulfilling an Urge.

Grump: Miser

Kithain Grumps and Thallain misers both offer their protection. Unlike grumps, who foster the next generation or save places and resources for those who come after themselves, misers jealously guard that which is theirs. They worked hard, fought, and bled for the spoils of their life, so no one else deserves what they have. Woe be to anyone who comes between them and what they claim as theirs.

Trigger: A miser risks Banality if she ever loses anything she considers hers.

Immunity: A miser knows trespassers should never be tolerated. She is not triggered for killing any mortal, chimera, or changeling who violates her property without permission.